

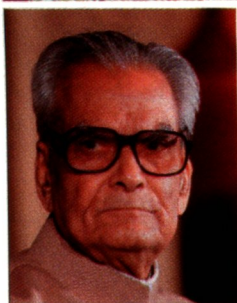
PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



COVER STORY:

EMBARRASSING CHOICE 18

Scandals and mud slinging have turned the Presidential polls into an embarrassment. Ghosts from the past have come to haunt the UPA candidate, Pratibha Patil, India's first woman who might be the President, putting both the Congress and its allies in a tight spot.



SUMET INDER SINGH

STATES: UTTAR PRADESH

Poor Little Rich Girl 30

Bucking the politicians' trend of concealing income and declaring assets that have quadrupled in three years, Mayawati remains unfazed as opponents hound her.



MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

BUSINESS&ECONOMY: LOW-COST COMPUTERS

The Race for the \$100 PC

40

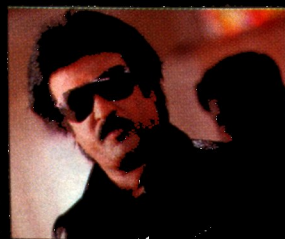


The low-cost PC is finally here, and from a home-grown technology company, which seeks to sell computing as a service.

SOCIETY&THE ARTS: CINEMA

The Boss

52



His 154th film reinforces Rajnikanth's status as a cultural phenomenon, unleashing a colourful and cacophonous social drama.

DEFENCE: PRIVATE SECTOR

The Private Arms Race 44



With private companies gaining entry in the defence sector, there is hope for ramping up competition and achieving self-sufficiency in the field.

SOCIETY&ARTS: TRADITIONAL TEXTILES

Root Cause

56

Designing talents across the country are rejuvenating traditional textiles, giving a new lease of life to age-old styles like bandhini.

CONTROVERSY: FASHION SHOWS

Couture Clash

65



Fall-outs and fee hikes. Two months before the spring-summer showing, the Fashion Design Council of India faces yet another fashion fracas.

OFFTRACK	9
INDIASCOPE	10
STATES	30
DIPLOMACY	48
DIASPORA	50
SOCIETY AND THE ARTS	52
EDUCATION	63
YOUR WEEK	68
EYECATCHERS	72

Turn to PG
Jobs Today 70

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PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR